Barbecue Pulled Pork Sandwiches

Main dishes | Instant Pot

Before you start

Makes: 12 sandwiches. Equipment: Instant Pot and two forks. High pressure: 1 hour, then quick-release, plus time to reach pressure and reduce the sauce. Brown sugar and water are divided.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Rub spices; add reserved sugar and measured salt/pepper

Bowl B - Cooking-liquid base; add reserved sugar and water

- [ ] 3 Tbsp light brown sugar, divided: 1 Tbsp for rub; 2 Tbsp for cooking liquid
- [ ] 2 tsp hot paprika [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 tsp mustard powder [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp ground cumin [Bowl A]
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] 4 lb boneless pork shoulder, trimmed and cut into 6 pieces
- [ ] 2 tsp vegetable oil
- [ ] 1/2 cup apple cider vinegar, plus more to taste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp tomato paste [Bowl B]
- [ ] 12 hamburger potato buns
- [ ] 1 cup barbecue sauce
- [ ] 4 cups coleslaw

- [ ] 2 3/4 cups water, divided: 3/4 cup for deglazing and 2 cups for cooking

1. Season and brown pork

1. Mix 2 tsp hot paprika, 1 tsp mustard powder, 1/2 tsp ground cumin, 1 Tbsp light brown sugar, 2 tsp kosher salt, and 1/2 tsp black pepper.

2. Rub over 4 lb boneless pork shoulder, trimmed and cut into 6 pieces. Reserve the other 2 Tbsp brown sugar (3 Tbsp total) for the cooking liquid.

3. Use 2 tsp vegetable oil and the Instant Pot sauté setting to brown pork in batches. Remove pork.

2. Pressure-cook

1. Pour in 3/4 cup water and scrape up browned bits.

2. Whisk in 1/2 cup apple cider vinegar, 3 Tbsp tomato paste, the reserved 2 Tbsp brown sugar, and another 2 cups water (2 3/4 cups water total).

3. Return pork and cook on high pressure for 1 hour. Quick-release and transfer pork to a bowl.

3. Reduce, shred, and serve

1. Simmer cooking liquid on sauté until reduced by about half, skimming excess fat.

2. Shred pork with two forks. Stir in about 3 cups reduced cooking liquid, and adjust salt and vinegar to taste.

3. Divide pork among 12 hamburger potato buns. Serve with 1 cup barbecue sauce and 4 cups coleslaw, divided among the sandwiches.